

Nikos Vasileiadis

Software Engineering Manager · Leeds, UK (GMT — same timezone as Ireland) · British & Greek (EU)

Citizen

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About Me

I started building websites as a teenager in northern Greece and turned a hobby into a 20-year career. After a decade of freelancing, teaching adults to use computers, and organising open-source conferences, I moved to Leeds in 2015 and found my way into engineering leadership — first through UX and Agile, then through platform teams and people management.

I'm currently an Engineering Manager at Utility Warehouse (FTSE 250), a UK multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile, and insurance — where I run platform services for the company's main website and lead a specialist engineering team. What I've learned across those years — working across financial services, regulated utilities, global retail, and public sector — is that the work I care most about is creating the conditions where people do their best work — through clarity, trust, and genuine investment in their growth.

Greek (EU) citizen — full right to work in Ireland and across the EU. Based in Leeds, same timezone as Dublin. Open to remote roles with Irish organisations.

What I'm About

- **People and teams** — keeping people, growing them, and getting out of their way. 100% retention across three company restructurings. 3 promotions I built the cases for — backed by DORA data. Heartbeat surveys for team wellbeing. I measure what matters and act on it.
- **Platform operations** — keeping critical services running and stakeholders supported across 15+ engineering teams.
- **Design systems** — from co-building an open-source design system to leading enterprise-wide adoption across 20 teams.
- **Commercial sense** — a £200k+ annual vendor portfolio across six platform services, CapEx/OpEx planning, vendor evaluation, and making sure engineering work connects to business outcomes.
- **Documentation** — I inherited undocumented systems and built a culture of writing things down. Over 100 articles and counting.

Experience

Software Engineering Manager

Utility Warehouse (Telecom Plus PLC · FTSE 250 — multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile & insurance)

Jul 2023 – Present · United Kingdom · Remote

I manage the platform and content engineering team — the people responsible for uw.co.uk and the services that sit behind it. At peak I had 8 technical reports across three teams with separate backlogs — web, mobile, and design systems. Six were direct reports; the other two were a Design Systems Lead and a Staff Engineer whose day-to-day management and 1:1s I held on a dotted line. A Product Manager alongside. Three rounds of company restructuring later — Platforms, Customer Experience, Partner — we're a specialist core of 2. Everyone who wanted to stay, stayed. Nobody left by choice.

What the team and I have done:

- **Kept people and grew them.** Supported 3 promotions (Associate → Mid, Mid → Senior) with evidence-based cases. Several people I mentored have since moved into Engineering Manager roles, both inside and outside UW. The 100% retention wasn't luck — it was the result of giving people clarity, trust, and genuine career investment.
- **Measured what mattered.** I started with manual team health tracking (TeamRetro) and custom DORA dashboards before the company rolled out DX. Now I use deployment frequency, lead time, change failure rate, and MTTR to understand delivery health — and that data directly feeds into promotion cases and bonus decisions. Alongside that, monthly Peakon Heartbeat surveys tell me how the team is actually doing — and I act on it. Performance isn't just throughput; it's whether people are in a position to sustain it.
- **Navigated restructurings.** When the organisation restructured — three times — I took responsibility for working out where the team should sit: mapping scope, talking to stakeholders, and building consensus. It wasn't in my job description; it needed doing. When the Customer Experience move brought mobile work into our remit, I negotiated to bring in a Senior Engineer who already had the expertise, rather than take on the backlog unprepared.
- **Fought for what mattered.** When one restructuring would have dissolved the Design Systems team, I pushed back and made the case for keeping it. That team went on to enable the company-wide rebrand.
- **Built a documentation culture from nothing.** We inherited a CMS that nobody had documented in years. I started by mapping what existed — we called it "Archaeology" — and built up from there. Over 100 articles of process and technical documentation now, from architecture decisions to onboarding guides.
- **Upskilled the team.** When we needed Kubernetes knowledge, I learned it first, trained the team, and documented it. I encouraged engineers to present at cross-team forums, own RFCs, and share what they knew — so they could operate independently across the full stack.
- **Hired well.** Involved in hiring 2 external engineers and bringing in 4 through internal transfers — from candidate assessment through to onboarding.
- **Delivered a company-wide rebrand (Oct 2025 – Apr 2026).** The team shipped the brand refresh across 522 pages of the uw.co.uk estate — the main website, the partner portal, the customer account system. We were the critical path: nobody else's rebrand work could go live until ours shipped. We wrote automated migration scripts that saved content editors hundreds of hours of manual work.
- **Kept the platform running.** uw.co.uk operated against a 99.99% SLO with a single incident this year — resolved within hours, zero downtime otherwise — and <3s page loads on critical pages. The estate includes 522 pages, 3,157 media assets, 1,090 shortlinks, and 218 redirects. We support 8 content teams (33 users) and 15+ engineering teams who depend on the platform. I'm responsible for six platform services — Contentful CMS, Google Tag Manager, Snowplow, Mixpanel, Optimizely, and OneTrust — monitored through Kubernetes, Sentry, Prometheus, Pingdom, and Cloudflare.
- **Led Design System adoption.** The Hearth Design System reached 20 engineering and product teams (15 full, 5 partial). Consolidating components at that level removed thousands of hours of duplicated engineering effort across the organisation. I also helped with R&D tax credit claims by translating the technical work into documentation that external advisors could audit.
- **Replaced the CMS.** The old CMS had no SLA, no SSO, and a dead tech stack. I ran a 2-month evaluation across 10 vendors, shortlisted to 3, and we went with Contentful — a six-figure annual enterprise contract; most vendors simply couldn't offer enterprise-grade SLAs and support. The migration was zero-disruption; three marketing teams (~18 people) gained content scheduling, structured models, and no more duplicated content.
- **Kept going with a small team.** When restructurings reduced us to 2 engineers, I absorbed Product Manager and on-call responsibilities alongside my management role. We continued to deliver across

6 platform services without breaching the platform SLO, with full accountability for the uw.co.uk estate.

Lead Software Engineer

Utility Warehouse (Telecom Plus PLC · FTSE 250 — multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile & insurance)

May 2022 – Jul 2023 · United Kingdom · Remote

I joined as the founding engineer in a standalone team supporting marketing — no department, no established processes, no documentation. It was built to make use of my cross-functional experience in engineering, UX, and delivery.

- We started as three — me, a Product Manager, and an Associate Engineer — and stayed that way for a full year before we grew. I line-managed that engineer from May 2022: there was no Head of Engineering in post and my own manager left a lot to me, so the people responsibility was mine 14 months before the title arrived. Two external hires in May 2023 took us to five, and the founding Associate was promoted to Software Engineer a month after that. Renamed Content Capability in Nov 2022, moved into Platforms in May 2023 — the first of three reorganisations the team would outlast.
- Set up a Scrum environment from scratch — structured backlog, predictable delivery, filling Product Manager gaps when needed. Mapped the legacy CMS through systematic discovery and wrote the team's foundational documentation.
- Led the vendor evaluation that resulted in UW adopting Contentful as its enterprise CMS.

Senior Full Stack Developer & Scrum Master

IMA-HOME

Jan 2020 – Apr 2022 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Combined frontend architecture with Scrum Master responsibilities for global clients including Adidas and MARS.

- Introduced Agile practices to an agency that had been running entirely on ad-hoc, fire-driven delivery. The result was measurable sprint velocity, predictable project allocation, and regular client demos — a step change in how the team worked.
- Architected the frontend for Royal Canin's (MARS) global web presence — a single design system serving 30+ countries including Japan and Saudi Arabia, with RTL and vertical reading direction support.

Senior Digital Developer & Scrum Master

Leeds Building Society (5th largest UK building society · £31B+ assets)

Oct 2018 – Jan 2020 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Maintained public-facing digital assets for the UK's 5th largest building society — a regulated financial services environment — while mentoring teams on code quality and UX standards.

- Introduced Agile and Scrum to the organisation for the first time — shifting from ad-hoc output to sprint-based delivery with measurable velocity. I was the primary driver for Agile adoption across the department throughout my time there.
- Appointed as Interim Scrum Master (Jun–Oct 2019) to stabilise delivery during their Digital Transformation programme, working alongside external consultants and cross-functional teams.

UX Interface Developer & Scrum Master

Jadu

Jan 2017 – Oct 2018 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Designed UIs and developed features for an award-winning CMS used by UK Local Authorities, universities, and third-sector organisations. Everything was built with accessibility and W3C standards as non-negotiables.

- Co-created **Pulsar** — an open-source UX and Interface Design System powering the Jadu Continuum Platform. This is where my design systems specialism started, and I'm still proud of it.
- Owned the full feature lifecycle — going out to council offices and universities for contextual research, writing up findings, building mockups, running usability tests, and shipping to production. One of three product-area leads, each responsible for their own domain.
- Gained hands-on Agile leadership through a rotating Scrum Master model.

Early Career, Teaching & Community

Oct 2005 – Dec 2016 (11 years)

The foundation years. Provincial northern Greece — Xanthi, where I grew up; Serres, where I studied: no tech industry to join and, after 2010, barely an economy. I built the career anyway — client by client — and led long before anyone gave me a title for it.

- **Web development & freelancing (2005–2015):** Delivered 40+ web projects across Greece and internationally — from local non-profits and bands to a Bitcoin job board for a client in California. Managed end-to-end client relationships, set up proper billing structures (40/40/20 payment terms), and coordinated with distributed teams. Started at 15 with my first website; bought my first domain in 2005.
- **Teaching & mentorship (2006–2012):** Earned a Certified Training Professional qualification and spent a year teaching ECDL to adult learners. Privately tutored a student in programming and hardware — that student went on to earn a BSc and MSc in Manchester and now works as an engineer at Sophos. One of my proudest outcomes.
- **Community & civic technology (2008–2014):** Co-founded the Serres Linux Users Group, organised FOSSCOMM 2012 (a 350-person national volunteer-powered conference), and managed the digital presence for UNESCO Serres, the local Natural History Museum, and community organisations. This community work directly shaped everything I went on to do in Leeds — GDG, IxDF, NUX.
- **UK agency work (2015–2016):** Relocated to Leeds. Built responsive e-commerce for global brands (Vivienne Westwood) and focused on frontend performance.

Community & Volunteering

Community organising has been a constant throughout my career — from Greece to Leeds.

Mentor, WRK digital (*Feb 2023–Present*): Mentoring engineers who have gone on to become Engineering Managers. Part of a peer network that spans EMs, Heads of Engineering, VPs, and CTOs.

Mentor, School of Code (*Aug 2023–Jan 2024*): Supported people making their first steps into the industry.

Lead Organiser, Google Developers Group Leeds (*Jan 2019–Mar 2020*): Revived an inactive chapter and ran conferences, workshops, and meetups. The highlight was a one-day conference in November 2019 with UK and international speakers — entirely volunteer-powered.

Education

International University of Greece — Serres Campus

BSc Informatics Engineering (2007–2012) — strong grades in software engineering, programming, and databases. Left without the certificate when the Greek economic crisis hit; the freelance business I was already running became the career.

Credentials

AI Leader: Generative AI & Agentic AI for Leaders & Founders · Udemy, Mar 2026

Team Topologies Distilled · Team Topologies Academy, Oct 2023

Mental Health First Aid Champion · MHFA England & UK Health Security Agency, 2022–2023

Professional Scrum Product Owner I (PSPO I) · Scrum.org, Aug 2021

Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I) · Scrum.org, Jun 2019

Full credentials list available on the [Credentials](#) page.